

the *Yassa* survive, but secondary sources suggest that it promoted obedience to Genghis Khan and unification of the nomadic clans and codified penalties for offenses.

**See also:** Zhou dynasty China 24

■ Plato's *Laws* 31

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## THE *SIETE PARTIDAS*

### 1256

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Compiled under Alfonso X of Castile in Spain, the *Siete Partidas* or Seven-Part Code provided legal, moral, and philosophical rules for all Castilians. Based on Roman law, it was designed to guide legislative judgments and offer a unified legal code for the whole kingdom. As the Spanish Empire grew in the 1500s, the *Siete Partidas* was exported to Latin America, where it remained influential until the 19th century.

**See also:** The Treaty of Tordesillas 86–87

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## THE TRIAL OF JOAN OF ARC

### 1431

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The trial of Joan of Arc before a Church court in Rouen, France, is one of the best documented of the Middle Ages. After seeing visions, Joan became convinced that she could drive the English out of France and help the Dauphin to be crowned King Charles VII. She led many successful battles against the English but was later captured by the Burgundians, French allies of the English. Joan was charged with 70 offenses, largely based on her claim to have received divine revelations, which was judged to be blasphemous. Found guilty of heresy, she was burned at the stake.

**See also:** The trial of Galileo Galilei 93 ■ The Salem witch trials 104–105

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## THE TRIAL OF MARTIN LUTHER

### 1521

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In 1517, Martin Luther nailed his Ninety-Five Theses, attacking the abuses of the Roman Catholic Church, to the door of a church in Wittenburg, Germany. The act is widely considered to mark the start of the Protestant Reformation—the movement challenging the Church's doctrines and practices. In 1521, the Pope excommunicated Luther, who was accused of heresy and put on trial in Worms before an imperial council of the Holy Roman Empire. Luther used the trial to defend and spread his ideas. An edict calling for his arrest ensued but was never enforced, as Frederick III of Saxony protected Luther, who continued his work, which ultimately contributed to the founding of Protestantism.

**See also:** The trial of Galileo Galilei 93

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## THE *SOBORNOYE ULOZHENIYE*

### 1649

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Before Russia's introduction of the *Sobornoye Ulozheniye* (law code of the Zemsky Sobor parliament) in 1649, corruption was widespread in a period known as the "Time of Trouble." Following civil unrest, a group of Muscovites, impressed by the stabilizing effects of law codes in nearby countries, demanded that Russia follow suit. Statesman Nikita Odoyevsky was tasked with compiling the code from Russian precedents and from Byzantine law (the Roman law that was influenced by Christian beliefs and in use from the 6th century CE until the fall of Constantinople in 1453). The new

code was extremely thorough; its 25 chapters covered religion, property, landholding, inheritance, commerce, travel permits, military service, and criminal law. The code also classed peasants as serfs and limited the power of the Orthodox Church.

**See also:** Slave codes 98–101

■ The Russian Constitution 190–191

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## THE *HABEAS CORPUS* ACT

### 1679

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England's Magna Carta, sealed in 1215, stated the concept of *habeas corpus*—that a person should not be unlawfully imprisoned—but in 1660, after the restoration of the monarchy, Parliament decided that it should be formally enshrined in law. *Habeas corpus* translates from Latin as "you shall have the body" and denotes in law that a person must be brought before a court to assess the lawfulness of their detention. A key tenet of common law today, *habeas corpus* has been suspended at various times in history, such as during World War II, when "enemy aliens" were held without charge.

**See also:** Magna Carta 66–71

■ The Glorious Revolution and the English Bill of Rights 102–103

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## THE *FATAWA-E-ALAMGIRI*

### Late 17th century

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The Mughal Empire's Sharia-based legal code, the *Fatawa-e-Alamgiri*, was named for Alamgir ("Conqueror of the World"), a title used by the emperor Aurangzeb, who introduced the code. Compiled by scholars of the Hanafi School, one of four schools of jurisprudence of Sunni Islam, it formed the basis of judicial law for India's Mughal Empire, covering all aspects of life, including family,